4.15 Rheumatic Heart Disease*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I had sore throats as a child." • Breathless on exertion **Objective** • Mitral murmur • Tires quickly with activity	**ACTUAL** Decreased activity tolerance related to valvular damage as evidenced by exertional dyspnea and fatigue.	• Vital signs stable and less breathlessness within 1 week.	• Follow vital signs and watch for heart failure. • Give medicines as prescribed. • Plan activity within her limits. • Note any irregular pulse, which may be atrial fibrillation.	• Considered met when symptoms are controlled.
Subjective • "Why do I need monthly injections?" **Objective** • On penicillin prophylaxis • Two doses missed	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to long-term antibiotic prophylaxis as evidenced by questioning.	• Explains what the prophylaxis is for and when it is due.	• Explain that it prevents rheumatic fever from coming back. • Give her a schedule card.	• Goal reached when she keeps to the schedule.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Damaged heart valves • Poor oral hygiene	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: damaged heart valves (endocarditis).	• Keeps her mouth healthy and reports fever.	• Teach oral hygiene and regular dental visits. • Ask her to report fever. • Advise telling the dentist about the rheumatic heart disease.	• Met when precautions are stated.

* **References for this care plan:** [16], [23], [32], [35]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.